

Cross-cultural proverb analysis

Review of the equivalence links in the proverbs-kr knowledge graph · Analyst: Ksenia · Draft 1, 15 September 2026

1. What this document is

The project collects proverbs from four languages — English, Persian, Italian and Albanian — and groups them under six tacit lessons. Sevda's knowledge graph (TriplyDB, dataset *proverbs-kr*: 931 triples, 28 proverbs, 48 links) automatically links every two proverbs from different languages that share a lesson, and classifies each link by comparing their source-domain tags. This document is the human review of those 48 links: it confirms or corrects each classification, explains why, and draws out what the comparison shows about the four languages.

Everything below is based on the data as it is in the graph today. Where the graph differs from the shared spreadsheet, the graph was used (see section 8).

2. Method

How the machine classified. The graph uses four equivalence types, defined in the ontology as: *DirectMatch* — same lesson and same source domain; *SameLessonDifferentImage* — same lesson, different image; *PartialOverlap* — no definition given; *FalseFriend* — same image, different lesson. The generation rule assigns *DirectMatch* when the two proverbs' source-domain tags are identical, and *SameLessonDifferentImage* otherwise. It never assigns *PartialOverlap* or *FalseFriend*, and it never links proverbs from different lessons — so *FalseFriend* cannot occur among the 48 links at all.

How the review classified. Each pair was read in the original language and in translation, together with its Situation of Use, and given one of the four types by these criteria:

- **DirectMatch** — same lesson and the same core image (the same scene or object), even if the tag wording differs slightly (e.g. 'Storm' vs 'Rain' for the same weather scene).
- **PartialOverlap** — same lesson, and the images share an element (water, sun, the sow/reap structure) or the same scene type, without being the same image.
- **SameLessonDifferentImage** — same lesson tag, no shared image element. When the tag is shared but the proverbs actually teach different lessons, the pair stays in this type and the note says so; the fix belongs upstream, in the lesson list (section 5, finding 2).
- **FalseFriend** — same image, different lesson, following the ontology's own definition.

These pairs are not among the 48 links; candidates are listed separately in section 6.

Bold in the 'Reviewed type' column marks a change from the machine's type.

3. Summary

Type	Machine	After review
DirectMatch	5	6

Type	Machine	After review
PartialOverlap	0	10
SameLessonDifferentImage	43	32
FalseFriend	0	0
Total links	48	48

Six links are direct matches after review (the machine found five; it missed the Italian–Albanian weather pair). Ten links are partial overlaps the machine could not see because it only tests for identical tags. Eleven links share a tag but not a lesson, because two of the six lessons bundle two different ideas each; they are kept as SameLessonDifferentImage and flagged in the notes. No link is a false friend, because the machine never links across lessons; four false-friend candidates exist in the data and are listed in section 6.

4. Review by lesson

4.1 Actions over intentions

ID	Lang.	Proverb	Literal translation	Image (source domain)	Situation of use
PRV-001	en	The road to hell is paved with good intentions.	The road to hell is paved with good intentions.	Hell, Road	Used to warn that having good intentions is not enough if the resulting actions end up causing harm or negative consequences.
PRV-002	fa	دوستی خاله خرسه	Aunt bear's friendship	Bear	When someone does something out of good intentions that ultimately ends up harming you.
PRV-015	ita	Tra il dire e il fare, c'è di mezzo il mare.	Between saying and doing, there is a sea.	Sea	Used to highlight that sometimes people don't

ID	Lang.	Proverb	Literal translation	Image (source domain)	Situation of use
					act on what they preach.
PRV-027	alb	Fjala pa vepër, si reja pa shi.	A word without a deed is like a cloud without rain.	Cloud, Deed, Rain	When someone keeps declaring good intentions but never acts on them.
PRV-028	alb	Më mirë armik i mençur se mik budalla.	Better a wise enemy than a foolish friend.	Enemy, Friend	When a well-meaning but foolish friend causes harm through clumsy help.

Pair	Machine type	Reviewed type	Analyst note
PRV-001 (en) – PRV-002 (fa)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	The tag is shared but the lessons are not the same. The English proverb says that your own good intentions can still lead you to a bad place. The Persian one comes from a folk tale: a bear, wanting to help its sleeping friend, crushes his head to swat a fly — a foolish friend's help does harm. Different agent, different moral. See lesson note.
PRV-001 (en) – PRV-015 (ita)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	Both say that intention or words are not deeds. English frames it as a moral warning (good intentions, bad destination); Italian as a plain observation (a

Pair	Machine type	Reviewed type	Analyst note
			whole sea between saying and doing). No shared image.
PRV-001 (en) – PRV-027 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	Same lesson: intentions or words without action are worth nothing. English uses the road to hell; Albanian a cloud that never rains — a promise that never delivers. No shared image.
PRV-001 (en) – PRV-028 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	The Albanian proverb is about a foolish friend being worse than a clever enemy — the same idea as the Persian bear, not as the English road. Linked only through the tag. See lesson note.
PRV-002 (fa) – PRV-015 (ita)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	Persian: harmful help from a foolish friend. Italian: the gap between saying and doing. These are not equivalents; they share only the tag.
PRV-002 (fa) – PRV-027 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	Persian: a friend's clumsy help. Albanian: empty words. Not equivalents; they share only the tag.
PRV-002 (fa) – PRV-028 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentImage	PartialOverlap	The closest pair in this lesson. Both teach that a foolish friend does more damage than an enemy. Persian tells it through a story (the bear is the friend); Albanian

Pair	Machine type	Reviewed type	Analyst note
			states it as a maxim. The Persian source-domain tag 'Bear' hides that its real domain is friendship — the proverb's own name is 'the friendship of Aunt Bear'. Adding 'Friend' to PRV-002 would let the machine see the overlap.
PRV-015 (ita) – PRV-027 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentImage	PartialOverlap	Both put a piece of nature between word and deed — a sea, a cloud without rain — and both are used to deflate someone who talks but does not act. Same rhetorical move, different natural element.
PRV-015 (ita) – PRV-028 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	Italian: saying vs doing. Albanian: foolish friend vs clever enemy. Different lessons under one tag.

Lesson note. This tag covers two different lessons. (a) Deeds over words or intentions: PRV-001 (road to hell), PRV-015 (sea between saying and doing), PRV-027 (cloud without rain). (b) A foolish friend's help does harm: PRV-002 (Aunt Bear), PRV-028 (wise enemy, foolish friend). The Situation of Use texts show the split clearly: PRV-002 and PRV-028 both describe a well-meaning friend causing harm; PRV-001, PRV-015 and PRV-027 describe someone not acting on what they say or intend.

Recommendation. Split the lesson in two. Five of the nine links in this group (001–002, 001–028, 002–015, 002–027, 015–028) would then disappear, which is correct — they are not equivalences.

4.2 Determination / Perseverance

ID	Lang.	Proverb	Literal translation	Image (source domain)	Situation of use
PRV-006	en	When there is	When there is	WayAbstract,	when

ID	Lang.	Proverb	Literal translation	Image (source domain)	Situation of use
		a will, there's a way.	a will, there's a way.	Will	someone wants to do something objectively difficult, this is used to encourage them to not give up.
PRV-007	fa	عاقبت جوینده، یابنده بود.	The seeker will eventually be the finder	Finder, Seeker	Used to encourage someone who has been working toward a goal for a long time so they don't give up.
PRV-020	ita	Chi cerca, trova.	Those who search, find.	Finder, Seeker	When someone looks for something, through persevering, they will find it.
PRV-029	alb	Kush kërkon, gjën.	Who seeks, finds.	Finder, Seeker	Encouraging someone that effort will eventually pay off.
PRV-030	alb	Gur mbi gur bëhet mur.	Stone upon stone, a wall is made.	Stones, Wall	Reassuring someone that small, steady efforts build a big result.

Pair	Machine type	Reviewed type	Analyst note
PRV-006 (en) – PRV-007 (fa)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	English is abstract (will opens a way); Persian is a person who searches and

Pair	Machine type	Reviewed type	Analyst note
			finds. Same encouragement, different vehicle. English also has 'Seek and ye shall find' (Matthew 7:7), which would be a direct match — it is not in the corpus.
PRV-006 (en) – PRV-020 (ita)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	As above, for Italian. Note that Italian has 'Volere è potere' (to want is to be able), a near-direct match for the English proverb — not in the corpus.
PRV-006 (en) – PRV-029 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	Abstract will/way against the Albanian seeker. Same encouragement, different vehicle.
PRV-006 (en) – PRV-030 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	English: willpower opens a path. Albanian: a wall is built stone by stone — perseverance as patient accumulation, not force of will. The Albanian adds a nuance (small steps, time) that the English does not carry.
PRV-007 (fa) – PRV-020 (ita)	DirectMatch	DirectMatch	Confirmed. Same image, almost the same wording. Persian and Italian may both descend from the same scriptural source (Matthew 7:7), which would explain the convergence better than independent

Pair	Machine type	Reviewed type	Analyst note
			invention.
PRV-007 (fa) – PRV-029 (alb)	DirectMatch	DirectMatch	Confirmed. Persian and Albanian are practically identical; the Albanian is the shortest of the three forms.
PRV-007 (fa) – PRV-030 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentI mage	SameLessonDifferentI mage	Seeking vs building. Both encourage persistence; the Albanian stresses gradual accumulation.
PRV-020 (ita) – PRV-029 (alb)	DirectMatch	DirectMatch	Confirmed. 'Chi cerca, trova' and 'Kush kërkon, gjen' have the same structure word for word (who seeks, finds). The clearest cross-cultural constant in the dataset: three of the four languages have it, and the fourth (English) has it too, just not sampled.
PRV-020 (ita) – PRV-030 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentI mage	SameLessonDifferentI mage	Seeking vs building, as for the Persian pair.

Lesson note. The seeker/finder image is the strongest constant in the dataset: Persian, Italian and Albanian all have it, and English has it too ('Seek and ye shall find', Matthew 7:7), just not in the sample. The three-way direct match is worth showing in the presentation. The Albanian 'stone upon stone' adds a nuance no other language in the sample has — perseverance as slow accumulation rather than as will or search.

4.3 Group vulnerability

ID	Lang.	Proverb	Literal translation	Image (source domain)	Situation of use
PRV-012	en	A chain is only as strong as its weakest link.	A chain is only as strong as its weakest link.	Chain, Link	Used to show how the strength of a group depends on every

ID	Lang.	Proverb	Literal translation	Image (source domain)	Situation of use
					individual's ability
PRV-013	fa	دیوار از جای شکسته می‌ریزد	A wall collapses from its broken part	Crack, Wall	When a project fails because of a small, ignored weakness or a vulnerable member.
PRV-025	ita	La catena si spezza sempre nel punto più debole	A chain breaks always in its weakest spot.	Chain, Link	Things crumble in the steps of a process that are weaker.
PRV-031	alb	Një dele e zgjebosur prish gjithë tufën.	One mangy sheep spoils the whole flock.	Flock, Sheep	Warning that one weak or bad member can damage the whole group.

Pair	Machine type	Reviewed type	Analyst note
PRV-012 (en) – PRV-013 (fa)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	Same mechanism — a whole fails at its weakest point — expressed through a chain (English) and a wall (Persian). No shared image, but the same structure of thought.
PRV-012 (en) – PRV-025 (ita)	DirectMatch	DirectMatch	Confirmed. Same image, same lesson; the Italian is a close counterpart of the English.
PRV-012 (en) – PRV-031 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	The Albanian proverb encodes a different lesson: one bad member spoils the others (contagion),

Pair	Machine type	Reviewed type	Analyst note
			like the English 'one bad apple spoils the barrel'. The chain proverb is about the weakest member causing failure, not about spreading. They share the tag, not the lesson. See lesson note.
PRV-013 (fa) – PRV-025 (ita)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	Wall vs chain: same 'weakest point' structure, different object.
PRV-013 (fa) – PRV-031 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	As with the chain: 'weakest point' (Persian wall) vs 'contagion' (Albanian sheep). Shared tag, different lesson.
PRV-025 (ita) – PRV-031 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	As above.

Lesson note. This tag also covers two lessons. (a) Weakest point: the whole fails where it is weakest — PRV-012, PRV-013, PRV-025. (b) Contagion: one bad member spoils the rest — PRV-031. The English equivalent of (b) is 'one bad apple spoils the barrel', not the chain.

Recommendation. Either retag PRV-031 under a new lesson ('One bad member spoils the group') or accept 'Group vulnerability' as a broad umbrella and record the sub-lesson in the notes. The first option is cleaner. Both Persian and Italian appear to have direct equivalents of the sheep proverb (see section 7).

4.4 Hidden depths / Deceptive appearances

ID	Lang.	Proverb	Literal translation	Image (source domain)	Situation of use
PRV-008	en	Still waters run deep.	Still waters run deep.	Depth, Water	Used to highlight how those who are quiet and reserved are actually quite knowledgeable.

ID	Lang.	Proverb	Literal translation	Image (source domain)	Situation of use
PRV-009	fa	از آن نترس که های و هو دارد، از آن بترس که سر به تو دارد	Don't fear the one who makes noise, fear the one who keeps their head down.	Noise, Posture	A warning about quiet people who hide their plans and can be more dangerous than loud, aggressive ones.
PRV-021	ita	L'acqua cheta rovina i ponti.	Still waters ruins bridges.	Bridge, Water	What is hidden ruins seemingly strong foundations.
PRV-032	alb	Uji i qetë të mbyt.	Quiet water drowns you.	Depth, Water	Warning to be wary of calm, quiet people who may be the most dangerous.

Pair	Machine type	Reviewed type	Analyst note
PRV-008 (en) – PRV-009 (fa)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	Different image and, more importantly, different tone. 'Still waters run deep' is neutral or admiring — the Situation of Use for PRV-008 says quiet people 'are actually quite knowledgeable'. The Persian is a warning: the quiet one is the dangerous one. Same topic (quiet people), opposite evaluation.
PRV-008 (en) – PRV-021 (ita)	SameLessonDifferentImage	PartialOverlap	Both use quiet water. But the English describes hidden depth (positive), while

Pair	Machine type	Reviewed type	Analyst note
			the Italian 'acqua cheta' is something hidden that quietly does damage. Shared image, divergent use — a good example of why the Situation of Use has to be part of the comparison.
PRV-008 (en) – PRV-032 (alb)	DirectMatch	DirectMatch	Confirmed on the image: still or quiet water in both. But note the tone: English admiring, Albanian a warning ('it drowns you'). Image match, only partial pragmatic match. The SituationOfUse class is the right place to record this difference.
PRV-009 (fa) – PRV-021 (ita)	SameLessonDifferentI mage	SameLessonDifferentI mage	No shared image (behaviour vs water), but the same use: a warning about quiet, hidden danger. Pragmatically these two are closer to each other than either is to the English.
PRV-009 (fa) – PRV-032 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentI mage	SameLessonDifferentI mage	Different image, same warning. The Persian and Albanian proverbs are used in the same situations (the two Situation of Use texts are almost interchangeable).
PRV-021 (ita) – PRV-032 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentI mage	PartialOverlap	Both use quiet water as a danger. The machine separated them because the tags differ ('Bridge' vs

Pair	Machine type	Reviewed type	Analyst note
			'Depth'), but the core image — quiet water that harms — is the same. Arguably a direct match; at minimum a partial overlap.

Lesson note. Image and use come apart here. Three of the four languages use quiet water (English, Italian, Albanian), but the English proverb is admiring (quiet people are knowledgeable) while the Italian and Albanian are warnings (quiet people are dangerous). The Persian uses a different image (noise vs lowered head) but agrees with Italian and Albanian in use. So the pragmatic grouping is {FA, ITA, ALB} against {EN}, while the image grouping is {EN, ITA, ALB} against {FA}. This is the best illustration in the corpus of why the SituationOfUse class matters and should be queried alongside the source domain.

4.5 Karma

ID	Lang.	Proverb	Literal translation	Image (source domain)	Situation of use
PRV-010	en	What goes around comes around.	What goes around comes around.	Circle, MotionAbstract	To warn people for how they treat others, because should they treat someone poorly, the same thing might happen to them.
PRV-011	fa	از هر دست بدهی، از همان دست می‌گیری	From whichever hand you give, from that same hand you receive	Hand	When someone suffers the exact same bad thing they did to another person, or to encourage good deeds.
PRV-023	ita	Chi semina vento, raccoglie tempesta.	Those who sow wind, will reap storm.	Storm, Wind	Who acts wrongly/chaotically will end up getting in

ID	Lang.	Proverb	Literal translation	Image (source domain)	Situation of use
					exchange the same behavior.
PRV-033	alb	Ç'të mbjellësh, do të korrësh.	What you sow, you shall reap.	Harvest, Sowing	Telling someone their actions, good or bad, will come back to them.
PRV-034	alb	Gropën që i hap tjetrit, bie vetë.	The pit you dig for another, you fall into yourself.	Pit, Trap	Warning that harm planned for others rebounds on the one who plans it.

Pair	Machine type	Reviewed type	Analyst note
PRV-010 (en) – PRV-011 (fa)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	English: abstract circular motion. Persian: the giving and receiving hand. Both are neutral reciprocity — good or bad comes back.
PRV-010 (en) – PRV-023 (ita)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	English is neutral; the Italian is specifically about wrongdoing that comes back larger (sow wind, reap a storm — from Hosea 8:7). Different image and narrower use.
PRV-010 (en) – PRV-033 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	English abstract, Albanian agrarian (sow/reap, cf. Galatians 6:7). Both neutral: you get back what you put out.
PRV-010 (en) – PRV-034 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	English neutral; Albanian is about a trap set for others that

Pair	Machine type	Reviewed type	Analyst note
			catches its maker — harm that rebounds. Narrower than the English.
PRV-011 (fa) – PRV-023 (ita)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	Hand (reciprocity) vs wind and storm (amplified punishment). Different image, different scope.
PRV-011 (fa) – PRV-033 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	Hand vs sowing. Both neutral reciprocity — same use, different vehicle.
PRV-011 (fa) – PRV-034 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	Reciprocity (Persian) vs rebounding harm (Albanian).
PRV-023 (ita) – PRV-033 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentImage	PartialOverlap	Both use the sow/reap structure; the Italian replaces the crop with wind and storm so that the return is worse than the deed. Both have Biblical ancestry (Hosea 8:7; Galatians 6:7), which explains the convergence.
PRV-023 (ita) – PRV-034 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentImage	SameLessonDifferentImage	Both are about harm that comes back on the doer, so they are used in the same situations; the images (storm vs pit) are unrelated.

Lesson note. Two sub-types: (a) neutral reciprocity — what you give comes back, good or bad: PRV-010, PRV-011, PRV-033; (b) harm rebounds on the doer: PRV-023, PRV-034. No split is needed, but pairs inside a sub-type are closer than pairs across them. Both agrarian proverbs (Italian wind/storm, Albanian sow/reap) have Biblical sources, and the Albanian pit proverb has direct equivalents in English, Italian and Persian that are not in the corpus (section 7). Convergence here is largely textual transmission, not independent invention.

4.6 Optimism in adversity

ID	Lang.	Proverb	Literal translation	Image (source domain)	Situation of use
PRV-003	en	Every cloud has a silver lining.	Every cloud has a silver lining.	Cloud, Silver	It's used to make someone who is in tough situation to feel better and give them a more positive perspective.
PRV-004	fa	پایان شب سیاه سپید است	The end of the black night is white	Night, White	Used to comfort someone in a difficult situation, giving them hope that things will get better.
PRV-005	fa	در ناامیدی بسی امید است	In despair there is much hope	Despair, Hope	Used as a reminder that solutions can be found in the darkest moments when someone has completely given up.
PRV-016	ita	Dopo il temporale, torna sempre il sereno.	After the rain comes the sun.	Storm, Sun	After challenging events, good events await.
PRV-035	alb	Pas shiut vjen dielli.	After the rain comes the sun.	Rain, Sun	Comforting someone in a hard moment that better days will follow.

Pair	Machine type	Reviewed type	Analyst note
PRV-003 (en) –	SameLessonDifferentI	SameLessonDifferentI	English: something

Pair	Machine type	Reviewed type	Analyst note
PRV-004 (fa)	mage	mage	good inside the bad (at the same time). Persian: the bad ends and good follows (in sequence). Different images and a slightly different kind of consolation.
PRV-003 (en) – PRV-005 (fa)	SameLessonDifferentI mage	PartialOverlap	Same structure — hope is found inside the bad situation itself. English gives it a weather image; the Persian (from Saadi) leaves it abstract.
PRV-003 (en) – PRV-016 (ita)	SameLessonDifferentI mage	PartialOverlap	Both weather. But English finds the good inside the cloud; Italian waits for the storm to pass. Shared domain, different structure.
PRV-003 (en) – PRV-035 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentI mage	PartialOverlap	As with the Italian: shared weather domain (cloud, rain), different structure (inside vs after).
PRV-004 (fa) – PRV-016 (ita)	SameLessonDifferentI mage	PartialOverlap	Night ending vs storm ending: the same sequence (darkness passes, light returns) with different scenery.
PRV-004 (fa) – PRV-035 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentI mage	PartialOverlap	End of the night, end of the rain: structurally identical, different scenery.
PRV-005 (fa) – PRV-016 (ita)	SameLessonDifferentI mage	SameLessonDifferentI mage	Abstract vs concrete, and different structure (hope inside despair vs calm after the storm).
PRV-005 (fa) –	SameLessonDifferentI	SameLessonDifferentI	As above.

Pair	Machine type	Reviewed type	Analyst note
PRV-035 (alb)	mage	mage	
PRV-016 (ita) – PRV-035 (alb)	SameLessonDifferentI mage	DirectMatch	The same scene: bad weather passes and the sun (il sereno) returns. The machine separated them only because one tagger wrote 'Storm' and the other 'Rain'. Recommend DirectMatch and harmonising the two tags.

Lesson note. Two structures: (a) the good is inside the bad — PRV-003 (silver lining), PRV-005 (hope in despair); (b) the good comes after the bad — PRV-004 (end of night), PRV-016 (after the storm), PRV-035 (after the rain). Pairs within a structure are close; across structures they share only the lesson. PRV-016 and PRV-035 describe the same scene and should be a direct match; the machine missed it because of tag wording (Storm vs Rain).

5. Findings across the corpus

1. **The machine under-counts similarity.** Testing for identical tags finds 5 direct matches. Reading the proverbs finds 6 direct matches and 10 partial overlaps. The difference comes entirely from tag wording ('Storm' vs 'Rain', 'Bridge' vs 'Depth', 'Bear' hiding 'Friend'). A short controlled vocabulary of coarse domains (Weather, Water, Animal, Body, Building, Journey, Agriculture, Social, Abstract) added as a second tag would let the machine compute PartialOverlap itself.
2. **Two of the six lessons are really two lessons each.** 'Actions over intentions' mixes *deeds over words* (PRV-001, 015, 027) with *a foolish friend does harm* (PRV-002, 028). 'Group vulnerability' mixes *weakest point* (PRV-012, 013, 025) with *contagion* (PRV-031). Eleven of the 48 links join proverbs across these sub-lessons and are not real equivalences. Splitting the two lessons would remove them. 'Karma' and 'Optimism in adversity' also have two sub-structures each, but these are variants of one lesson and do not need splitting.
3. **Image and use can come apart.** English, Italian and Albanian share the quiet-water image, but the English proverb praises quiet people while the Italian and Albanian warn against them; the Persian uses a different image and agrees with the Italian and Albanian in use. The Situation of Use should therefore be part of any comparison query, not only the source domain.
4. **Where the languages converge, there is usually a shared text behind it.** Seeker/finder (Matthew 7:7), sow/reap (Galatians 6:7, Hosea 8:7) and the pit dug for others (Proverbs 26:27) are all scriptural; Persian has its own classical sources for two of them. Convergence in this corpus is better explained by transmission than by independent invention — a point worth one sentence in the report's discussion.
5. **The sampled images sort the four languages into rough profiles.** English: abstract or

mechanical (road, chain, circle, will). Persian: body, social behaviour and narrative (hand, posture, the bear tale), plus the night. Italian: natural elements (sea, storm, wind, water), plus the chain. Albanian: agrarian and pastoral (sheep, sowing, stones, pit), plus weather. The sample is small — five to nine proverbs per language, chosen by one speaker each — so these are tendencies in the sample, not claims about the languages.

6. **The direct-match count is partly an artefact of sampling.** Each language contributed one or two proverbs per lesson. For several proverbs the other languages have well-known direct equivalents that simply were not chosen (section 7). Adding them would raise the number of direct matches and make the 'same lesson, different image' pattern more meaningful, because it would then be a finding rather than a side-effect of what was sampled.

6. False-friend candidates

The ontology defines FalseFriend as 'same image, different lesson', but the generation rule only links proverbs that share a lesson, so the type is never used. Reading the source-domain tags across lessons gives these candidates (query 11.5 finds them automatically). The first two are cross-language and could be added as FalseFriend links; the last two are within one language and are only an observation.

Shared image term	Proverb A	Proverb B	Comment
Cloud	PRV-003 (en): Every cloud has a silver lining.	PRV-027 (alb): A word without a deed is like a cloud without rain.	English cloud with a silver lining (optimism) vs Albanian cloud without rain (empty words). Same object, opposite mood. A genuine false friend across languages.
Wall	PRV-013 (fa): A wall collapses from its broken part	PRV-030 (alb): Stone upon stone, a wall is made.	Persian wall that collapses at its crack (group vulnerability) vs Albanian wall built stone by stone (perseverance). Same object, unrelated lessons.
Rain	PRV-027 (alb): A word without a deed is like a cloud without rain.	PRV-035 (alb): After the rain comes the sun.	Both Albanian. Rain that never comes (empty words) vs rain that ends (optimism). Same language, so not a cross-cultural link, but it shows the image is not the lesson.

Shared image term	Proverb A	Proverb B	Comment
Storm	PRV-016 (ita): After the rain comes the sun.	PRV-023 (ita): Those who sow wind, will reap storm.	Both Italian. Storm that passes (optimism) vs storm reaped from wind (karma). Same language; same observation as above.

7. Suggested additions to the corpus

Direct equivalents that exist in the other languages but are not in the dataset. They are listed from the analyst's knowledge and need to be confirmed by the native speaker in the group before being added.

Would match	Language	Candidate proverb	Verify with
PRV-031 (alb) one mangy sheep spoils the flock	Persian	یک بز گر گله را گر می‌کند — one mangy goat makes the whole flock mangy	Saba
PRV-031 (alb) one mangy sheep spoils the flock	Italian	Una mela marcia guasta tutto il cesto — one rotten apple spoils the whole basket	Claudia
PRV-031 (alb) one mangy sheep spoils the flock	English	One bad apple spoils the (whole) barrel	—
PRV-034 (alb) the pit you dig for another	Persian	چاه مکن بهر کسی، اول خودت — don't dig a well for someone: first you, then them	Saba
PRV-034 (alb) the pit you dig for another	Italian	Chi scava la fossa agli altri ci cade dentro — who digs the pit for others falls in it	Claudia
PRV-034 (alb) the pit you dig for another	English	Whoever digs a pit will fall into it (Proverbs 26:27)	—
PRV-027 (alb) word without deed	Persian	دو صد گفته چون نیم کردار — two hundred sayings are not worth half a deed (Ferdowsi)	Saba
PRV-006 (en) where there's a will	Italian	Volere è potere — to want is to be able	Claudia

Would match	Language	Candidate proverb	Verify with
PRV-006 (en) where there's a will	Persian	خواستن توانستن است — to want is to be able	Saba
PRV-007 / 020 / 029 seeker–finder	English	Seek, and ye shall find (Matthew 7:7)	—
PRV-021 / 032 quiet water	Persian	آب زیر کاه — water under the straw (a deceptively calm, sly person; an idiom rather than a full proverb)	Saba

8. Data checks

- **Italian entries differ between the sheet and the graph.** The shared spreadsheet has two Italian proverbs per lesson (PRV-014 to PRV-026) that are literal translations of the English or Persian ones. The graph has one Italian proverb per lesson (PRV-015, 016, 020, 021, 023, 025), and they are authentic Italian proverbs with different text under the same IDs (e.g. PRV-021 is 'L'acqua cheta nasconde profondità' in the sheet and 'L'acqua cheta rovina i ponti' in the graph). The graph's version is the better one and was used here. The sheet should be updated to match, and PRV-014, 017, 018, 019, 022, 024, 026 retired.
- **Situation of Use** is filled for all 28 proverbs in the graph but empty for most English and Italian rows in the sheet. Copy the graph's texts back into the sheet.
- **Language codes** mix styles: 'en' and 'fa' (ISO 639-1) with 'ita' and 'alb' (three-letter, and 'alb' is not the ISO code — 'sq' or 'sqi'). Pick one scheme: en / fa / it / sq, or eng / fas / ita / sqi.
- **annotatedBy** is defined in the ontology but empty on all 48 links. Once this review is agreed, it should be set (e.g. 'Ksenia', with the native speaker's name added where they confirmed the reading).
- **SPARQL works without a started service.** The TriplyDB dataset has no dedicated service, but TriplyDB's built-in engine answers queries, so the dataset's SPARQL page and the API endpoint both work (checked 15 September). The queries in section 11 were all run against the live graph.

9. Changes proposed for the graph

1. Set the reviewed types from section 4 on the 48 links (11 changes: 016–035 to DirectMatch; 002–028, 015–027, 008–021, 021–032, 023–033, 003–005, 003–016, 003–035, 004–016, 004–035 to PartialOverlap) and set annotatedBy.
2. Replace the 'Auto-derived' divergence notes with the analyst notes from section 4.
3. Split 'Actions over intentions' into 'Deeds over words' and 'A foolish friend does harm'; split 'Group vulnerability' into 'Weakest point' and 'One bad member spoils the group' — or, if the group prefers to keep six lessons, record the sub-lesson in the note.
4. Add 'Friend' to the source domains of PRV-002; harmonise 'Storm'/'Rain' and 'Bridge'/'Depth'.

5. Add the two cross-language FalseFriend links from section 6.
6. Add the confirmed proverbs from section 7 and re-run the link generation.

10. Open questions for the group

1. Which Italian set is final — the graph's or the sheet's? (Claudia)
2. Can Saba and Claudia confirm the Persian and Italian candidates in section 7, and the readings of their proverbs in section 4?
3. Do we split the two mixed lessons, or keep six and note the sub-lessons?
4. Should the SPARQL queries in section 11 go into the final analysis section as they are, or be presented as competency questions?

11. Queries that reproduce the findings

All eight run on the dataset's SPARQL page (triplifydb.com/SevdaRezaeiMelal/proverbs-kr/sparql). The result noted under each query is what the graph returned on 15 September, before any of the changes in section 9.

11.1 How many links of each type

```
PREFIX p: <http://example.org/proto#>
SELECT ?type (COUNT(*) AS ?links)
WHERE { ?e a p:CrossCulturalEquivalence ; p:hasEquivalenceType ?type }
GROUP BY ?type
```

Result: SameLessonDifferentImage 43, DirectMatch 5. PartialOverlap and FalseFriend are never assigned — the starting point of section 3.

11.2 Every link with both proverbs, languages and type

```
PREFIX p: <http://example.org/proto#>
SELECT ?pair ?langA ?proverbA ?langB ?proverbB ?type
WHERE {
  ?pair a p:CrossCulturalEquivalence ;
    p:linksProverbA ?a ; p:linksProverbB ?b ; p:hasEquivalenceType
    ?type .
  ?a p:hasLanguage ?langA ; p:hasTranslation ?proverbA .
  ?b p:hasLanguage ?langB ; p:hasTranslation ?proverbB .
}
```

Result: 48 rows. This is the list that section 4 reviews; no link joins two proverbs of the same language.

11.3 Direct matches between two given languages (here Italian and Albanian)

```
PREFIX p: <http://example.org/proto#>
SELECT ?proverbA ?proverbB
```

```

WHERE {
  ?pair p:hasEquivalenceType p:DirectMatch ;
        p:linksProverbA ?a ; p:linksProverbB ?b .
  ?a p:hasLanguage "ita" ; p:hasText ?proverbA .
  ?b p:hasLanguage "alb" ; p:hasText ?proverbB .
}

```

Result: one row — 'Chi cerca, trova' / 'Kush kërkon, gjen'. Change the two language codes to compare any other pair of languages.

11.4 Source-domain terms that appear in more than one language

```

PREFIX p: <http://example.org/proto#>
SELECT ?domain (GROUP_CONCAT(DISTINCT ?lang; separator=", ") AS
?languages) (COUNT(DISTINCT ?lang) AS ?n)
WHERE { ?prov p:hasSourceDomain ?domain ; p:hasLanguage ?lang }
GROUP BY ?domain
HAVING (COUNT(DISTINCT ?lang) > 1)
ORDER BY DESC(?n)

```

Result: Seeker and Finder (fa, ita, alb), Water (en, ita, alb), then Cloud, Depth, Chain, Link, Wall, Sun in two languages each. This is the evidence for finding 5 (convergences) and for the tag-wording problem in finding 1: Sun is shared by ita and alb, but Storm/Rain are not, which is why the machine missed PRV-016 – PRV-035.

11.5 False-friend candidates: same image term, different lesson

```

PREFIX p: <http://example.org/proto#>
SELECT ?domain ?a ?lessonA ?b ?lessonB
WHERE {
  ?a p:hasSourceDomain ?domain ; p:hasLesson ?lessonA ; p:hasLanguage
?langA .
  ?b p:hasSourceDomain ?domain ; p:hasLesson ?lessonB ; p:hasLanguage
?langB .
  FILTER (?lessonA != ?lessonB && STR(?a) < STR(?b))
}

```

Result: Cloud (PRV-003 / PRV-027), Wall (PRV-013 / PRV-030), Storm (PRV-016 / PRV-023), Rain (PRV-027 / PRV-035) — exactly the four pairs in section 6. The machine cannot produce these because it only links within a lesson; this query does.

11.6 Lessons that have no direct match at all

```

PREFIX p: <http://example.org/proto#>
SELECT ?lesson
WHERE {
  ?lesson a p:TacitLesson .
  FILTER NOT EXISTS {
    ?e p:hasEquivalenceType p:DirectMatch ; p:linksProverbA ?x .
    ?x p:hasLesson ?lesson
  }
}

```

}

Result: Actions over intentions, Karma, Optimism in adversity. After the change proposed for PRV-016 – PRV-035, Optimism would leave this list.

11.7 How many proverbs each language contributed to each lesson

```
PREFIX p: <http://example.org/proto#>
SELECT ?lesson ?lang (COUNT(?prov) AS ?proverbs)
WHERE { ?prov p:hasLesson ?l ; p:hasLanguage ?lang . ?l p:hasLabel
?lesson }
GROUP BY ?lesson ?lang
ORDER BY ?lesson ?lang
```

Result: one proverb per language per lesson, except Albanian (two in Actions, Determination and Karma) and Persian (two in Optimism). This is the sampling imbalance behind finding 6.

11.8 Everything linked to one proverb, with the situation of use (here PRV-032, 'Uji i qetë të mbyt')

```
PREFIX p: <http://example.org/proto#>
PREFIX rdfs: <http://www.w3.org/2000/01/rdf-schema#>
SELECT ?other ?lang ?proverb ?type ?situation
WHERE {
  { ?e p:linksProverbA p:PRV-032 ; p:linksProverbB ?other }
  UNION
  { ?e p:linksProverbB p:PRV-032 ; p:linksProverbA ?other }
  ?e p:hasEquivalenceType ?type .
  ?other p:hasLanguage ?lang ; p:hasTranslation ?proverb ; p:usedIn ?s
  .
  ?s rdfs:label ?situation .
}
```

Result: PRV-008 (en, DirectMatch — 'quiet people are knowledgeable'), PRV-009 (fa — 'quiet people are dangerous'), PRV-021 (ita — 'what is hidden ruins foundations'). The situation texts show the tone split described in section 4.4. Replace PRV-032 with any other ID.